

AWS Cost Explorer - Overview

AWS Cost Explorer is a built-in AWS tool that allows you to visualize, analyze, and manage your AWS costs and usage over time. It provides detailed insights that help businesses optimize their cloud spending.

Key Features of AWS Cost Explorer

Feature	Description
Cost & Usage Reports	Breaks down AWS costs by service, region, account, or tags.
Granularity Options	View data daily, monthly, or by custom date ranges.
Filtering & Grouping	Filter by services, linked accounts, regions, usage types, and tags.
Forecasting	Predicts future costs based on historical data.
Reports	Save custom reports for repeated use and scheduling.
Integration	Works with AWS Budgets and Cost Anomaly Detection for better cost management.

Common Use Cases

- Track **monthly spend** by AWS service.
 - Analyze costs by **region** or **account**.
 - Identify **spending spikes** or **cost anomalies**.
 - Forecast future AWS expenses.
 - Allocate costs across teams using **resource tags**.
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How to Access AWS Cost Explorer

1. Go to the [AWS Management Console](#).
 2. Navigate to:
Billing → **Cost Explorer**
 3. Click **Launch Cost Explorer**
 4. (Optional) Enable Cost Explorer if it's not already turned on.
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Quick Start Steps

1. **Launch Cost Explorer**
 2. Choose a **Time Range** (e.g., last 6 months)
 3. Set **Granularity**: Daily or Monthly
 4. **Group By**:
 - Service
 - Region
 - Linked Account
 - Tag
 5. Apply **Filters** (e.g., only EC2, or specific accounts)
 6. Save the view as a **report** for future reference.
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Forecasting Example

- **Scenario:** You want to forecast total AWS costs for the next 3 months.
- **Steps:**

1. In Cost Explorer, go to **Forecasts** tab.
2. Select service (or "All Services").
3. AWS uses past 12 months' data to estimate future costs.
4. Adjust date range and see expected spend.

Pro Tips

- **Enable tags** like **Project**, **Environment**, or **Team** for detailed cost allocation.
 - **Schedule reports** to be emailed weekly or monthly.
 - Use **AWS Budgets** to set custom alerts.
 - Use **Linked Accounts** in an organization for centralized billing.
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